

World Religions 30
Assignment Booklet #3
Chapter 3: Early Religions

Name: _____

Part One: Multiple-Choice Items

Read each item carefully and decide which choice best completes the statement or answers the question. Type the letter of your choice in the blank space before the item. (20 marks).

_____	1. Early religions differed from myth-driven systems because they often emphasized A. philosophical and ethical inquiry B. rejection of ritual C. military expansion D. scientific materialism
_____	2. Zoroaster is associated with A. Zoroastrianism B. Shinto C. Jainism D. Taoism
_____	3. Ahura Mazda is the name of A. the one God in Zoroastrianism B. a Shinto shrine C. a Jain monk D. a Confucian book
_____	4. Jainism places especially strong emphasis on A. ahimsa or non-violence B. conquest C. sacrifice of enemies D. political office
_____	5. Mahavira is associated with A. Jainism B. Taoism C. Shinto D. Confucianism
_____	6. The Tao is best described as A. the Way or natural order B. a temple gate C. a Persian fire altar D. a legal code
_____	7. Confucian thought places strong value on A. proper relationships and social harmony B. total withdrawal from society C. worship of many gods D. rejection of education
_____	8. In Shinto, kami are A. sacred presences or spirits B. Buddhist monks C. legal scholars D. Persian rulers
_____	9. A torii gate is most closely linked with A. Shinto B. Jainism C. Zoroastrianism D. Confucianism
_____	10. Chuang Tzu's butterfly story raises questions about A. identity and perception B. taxation policy C. temple architecture D. military rank
_____	11. Yin and yang are most associated with A. Taoist balance

	B. Zoroastrian fire worship C. Jain monastic law D. Shinto torii
_____	12. Which tradition is often described more as an ethical or philosophical system than a worship tradition? A. Confucianism B. Shinto C. Jainism D. Zoroastrianism
_____	13. Fire in Zoroastrianism often symbolizes A. purity and divine presence B. disbelief C. ancestor rejection D. political rebellion
_____	14. Which tradition is strongly associated with ritual purity and shrine practice in Japan? A. Shinto B. Taoism C. Jainism D. Zoroastrianism
_____	15. Living in harmony with the natural order best fits A. Taoism B. Confucianism C. Jainism D. Zoroastrianism
_____	16. Ren and li are most closely connected to A. Confucianism B. Shinto C. Jainism D. Zoroastrianism
_____	17. Which tradition is famous for care not to harm living beings? A. Jainism B. Shinto C. Taoism D. Zoroastrianism
_____	18. A key theme uniting many early religions is the search for A. meaning and right living B. political domination C. rejection of ethics D. one identical creed
_____	19. Which pair is correctly matched? A. kami - Shinto B. Ahura Mazda - Jainism C. ren - Taoism only D. ahimsa - Zoroastrianism
_____	20. The emergence of early religions shows that human beings were increasingly interested in A. profound questions about existence B. ending all ritual life C. replacing ethics with trade D. worshipping only local rulers

Part Two: Matching

Choose the letter of the term that best describes the concept or completes the sentence. Terms may be used more than once, and not all terms will be used. Enter the letter of the term into the blank space beside each statement. (15 marks).

Answer	Statement	Terms
_____	1. The teacher traditionally associated with the rise of Zoroastrianism.	A. Zoroaster B. Ahura Mazda C. dualism D. Mahavira E. ahimsa F. Tao G. yin and yang H. Confucius I. ren J. li K. kami L. torii M. ritual purity N. harmony O. philosophy
_____	2. The supreme divine reality preached by Zoroaster.	
_____	3. A way of seeing reality as a struggle between opposed forces such as good and evil.	
_____	4. A key teacher of Jainism.	
_____	5. The principle of radical non-harm toward living beings.	
_____	6. The Way or natural order with which a person should live in harmony.	
_____	7. A symbol of complementary forces held in balance.	
_____	8. The teacher whose ideas stressed moral character and social order.	
_____	9. A Confucian virtue often associated with humaneness or benevolence.	
_____	10. Confucian ritual propriety and proper conduct in relationships.	
_____	11. Sacred presences or spirits in Shinto.	
_____	12. A gate that marks the approach to a Shinto shrine.	
_____	13. The removal of pollution or defilement before sacred action.	
_____	14. A goal valued strongly in Taoist and Confucian thought, though in different ways.	
_____	15. A disciplined search for wisdom, meaning, and how to live well.	

Part Three: True or False

Read each statement carefully and decide if it is true or false. Type T or F in each blank beside the statement to indicate your choice for each. (15 marks).

_____	1. Early religions always rejected ethics and focused only on myth.
_____	2. Zoroaster is associated with a faith centered on Ahura Mazda.
_____	3. Jainism encourages careful non-violence toward living beings.
_____	4. The Tao can be described as the natural order or the Way.
_____	5. Confucianism is unconcerned with human relationships.
_____	6. Kami are important in Shinto.
_____	7. A torii gate is commonly linked with a Shinto shrine.
_____	8. Yin and yang suggest balance between complementary forces.
_____	9. Ahimsa supports cruelty to animals.
_____	10. Some early religions moved toward philosophy as well as ritual.
_____	11. Shinto has no concern with purity.
_____	12. Ren and li are key terms in Confucian thought.
_____	13. All early religions teach exactly the same thing.
_____	14. Chuang Tzu's butterfly story raises questions about identity and reality.
_____	15. Questions about how to live well were important in many early religions.

Part Four: Written-Response Items

Respond to the following items on the lines below the items. Attach additional pages if you need more space. (48 marks).

1. Explain how early religions differ from more myth-driven belief systems. (4 marks)

2. What question about identity or reality is raised by Chuang Tzu's butterfly story? (4 marks)

3. Summarize the core teaching of Zoroaster and the role of Ahura Mazda. (4 marks)

4. Explain the meaning of ahimsa in Jainism and why it affects everyday behaviour. (4 marks)

5. Describe the Tao and explain why harmony matters in Taoism. (4 marks)

6. Compare yin and yang with the idea of balance in daily life. (4 marks)

7. Explain how Confucianism uses ren and li to guide human relationships. (4 marks)

8. Describe the meaning of kami in Shinto. (4 marks)

9. Why do ritual purity and shrine practices matter in Shinto? (4 marks)

10. Compare Taoism and Confucianism as two different responses to the question of how to live well. (4 marks)

11. Choose one early religion from the chapter and explain how it shaped the culture around it. (4 marks)

12. Explain why philosophy, ethics, and ritual all mattered in the development of early religions. (4 marks)

Part Five: Student-Choice

Select either Option A or Option B and complete the associated tasks. Use reliable sources and attach additional pages if you need more room. (16 marks).

Option A: Founder or Sage Profile

Using reliable sources, research one founder, teacher, or sage connected to an early religion from the chapter. Then respond to the following items:

1. Identify the person you selected and the tradition with which the person is associated. (2 marks)

2. Summarize the person's key teachings or influence in sufficient detail. (4 marks)

3. Explain how those teachings addressed a human problem such as suffering, order, or identity. (4 marks)

4. Describe one way the person still matters today. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

Option B: Compare Two Early Religions

Choose any two traditions from Chapter 3 and compare them using reliable sources. Then respond to the following items:

1. Identify the two traditions you selected. (2 marks)

2. Explain one important similarity between them. (4 marks)

3. Explain one important difference between them. (4 marks)

4. State which tradition you think gives a more useful answer to the question of how to live well, and explain why. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

End of Assignment Booklet 3

After you have completed all items, submit your work according to your course instructions.